



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

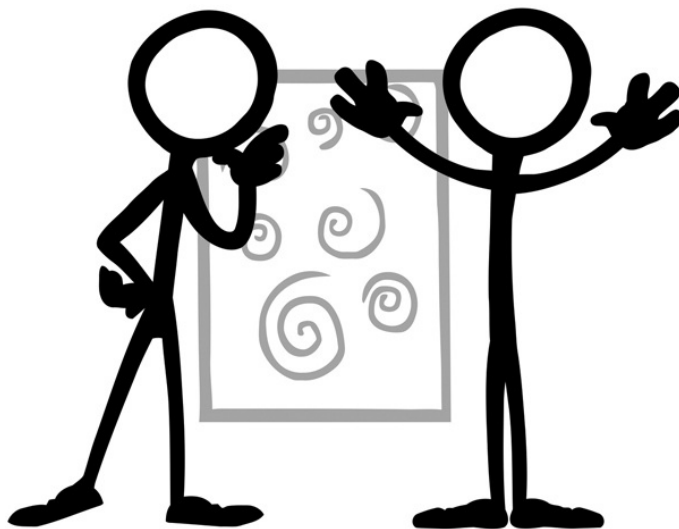
CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

That makes a lot of sense!



Learning Outcome

Describe detailed facts about events or actions in work and social contexts, in written or spoken situations.

Ask your partner:

- Do you think you are convincing when you are trying to give your point of view? Why or why not?
- What are some ways people can give convincing arguments?

Can Do Statements

- I can express beliefs, opinions, and annoyance.
- I can report details, reasons, or results of events or actions.
- I can describe past habits.





Let's Explore!

Todd Jefferson gives a speech about how to make a **convincing*** argument.

* Something that is "*convincing*" convinces you (or leads you) to do something or think in a certain way.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

It's nice to see so many familiar faces in the crowd. I hope you all know what a special club this is! My name is Todd Jefferson, and tonight I'm going to talk to you about how to make a convincing argument. I used to work in the legal system, so at that time, I was using arguments like the air we breathe. Arguments are won not by having the best facts, but by expressing them in the best way. You'd never believe what problems you can avoid by using effective techniques of communication.

First, take my example about arguments being like the air we breathe. This is an analogy. It gives you a mental picture of words and ideas. It's amazing how effective analogies can be. Secondly, facts do matter. As a lawyer, I was trying to find legal examples to support my case. In my view, an argument about economics or politics has no merit if it's not backed up with history and statistics. Otherwise, it's just an opinion. We all have equally valid opinions, but my argument is only superior to yours if I support it with facts.

Thirdly, you should always be constructive. I used to write speeches for an ambitious local politician. My secret to writing convincing speeches was figuring out how you could use opinion and facts to help people, not to destroy them.

Finally, you have to strike an optimistic tone. Try to avoid negative thinking: "I've had enough of this!" Sometimes, you need to be courageous to find positive things to say. I maintain that there are many things to be positive about in the world.





Let's Practice!

Todd has a number of opinions.

Instructions: Select the correct options to answer the question: which sentences show a person's opinion or annoyance? Read the correct options aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- ☐ 1. Thirdly, you should always be constructive.
- ☐ 2. It's nice to see so many familiar faces in the crowd.
- ☐ 3. Sometimes, you need to be courageous to find positive things to say.
- ☐ 4. Do facts matter?
- ☐ 5. I've had enough of this!
- ☐ 6. I maintain that there are many things to be positive about in the world.
- ☐ 7. It gives you a mental picture of words and ideas.
- ☐ 8. In my view, an argument about economics or politics has no merit if it's not backed up with history and statistics.
- ☐ 9. This is an analogy.



Let's Practice!

Let's talk about habits.

Instructions: Select the appropriate word in bold to complete each sentence.

- 1) I was always trying to find **royal** / **legal** examples to support my case.
- 2) I used to **work** / **walk** in a legal system.
- 3) I was **reacting** / **using** arguments like the air we breathe.
- 4) My secret to writing convincing **speeches** / **pitches** was figuring out how you could use opinion.
- 5) I used to write speeches for an ambitious local **politician** / **music**.





Extension Activity

Make a list of strategies for making a good argument.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a list of the strategies for making a good argument that are discussed in this lesson.
- With a partner, discuss other ways of making a good argument.
- Go online. Find more strategies for making a good argument. Find at least 10 strategies.
- Write 2-3 sentences summarizing each strategy.
- Read your list to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I discuss strategies for making a good argument.

☐ ☐

I read about strategies for making a good argument.

☐ ☐

I write a list describing each strategy.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **analogy** (noun): a use of language that compares one thing to something else
e.g. Take my example about arguments being like the air we breathe. This is an analogy.
- **familiar face** (noun): someone you know
e.g. It's nice to see so many familiar faces in the crowd.
- **like the air we breathe** (expression): very common; plentiful
e.g. I used to work in the legal system, so at that time, I was using arguments like the air we breathe.
- **to have (no) merit** (expression): to (not) deserve
e.g. An argument about economics or politics has no merit if it's not backed up with history and statistics demonstrating the case.
- **valid** (adjective): acceptable; logical; reasonable
e.g. We all have equally valid opinions, but my argument is only superior to yours if I support it with facts.
- **to be backed up** (expression): to be supported
e.g. Arguments need to be backed up with precise facts.





Learning Points

The Wh-Clause in Exclamations

You can use the wh-clause for exclamations. These sentences can show strong feelings.

If you want to make an exclamatory sentence, you can use **what** or **how**. Follow the same structure as with the other wh-clauses. You can also use an exclamation mark at the end of these sentences.

Examples:

*It's wonderful **how** lovely the weather is!*

What a beautiful baby! (use of a/an with singular countable nouns)

What beautiful children! (no article with plural countable nouns)

When you use **what** with plural and noncount nouns, or **how**, it is sometimes difficult to decide whether it is an exclamation or a regular wh-clause. The background information or context is usually what helps you to decide.

Examples:

*You don't know **what** obstacles I've faced!*

*You don't know **what** the obstacles were that I faced.*

*I can't believe **how** well she speaks!*

*I can't believe **how** she speaks so well.*

Examples:

- *I hope you all know what a special club this is!*
- *You'd never believe what problems you can avoid by using effective techniques of communication.*





Learning Points

Past Continuous for Temporary Habitual Action

You can use the Past Continuous or Past Progressive verb tense to talk about temporary repeated actions in the past.

Not everything in life is permanent. If you want to talk about a habit in the past that was temporary, you can use the Past Continuous tense.

How to form the Past Continuous:

form of *be*' + verb- ing

I He/ She/ it	was (wasn't)	eating
You We They	were (weren't)	

- *Last year, I studied English in Canada for six months. I **was speaking** in English for almost 8 hours a day with my friends. Also, I **wasn't smoking** a lot since the cigarettes there were very expensive.*

Examples:

- *I used to work in the legal system, so at that time, I was using arguments like the air we breathe.*
- *My secret to writing convincing speeches was figuring out how you could use opinion and facts to help people, not to destroy them.*

